UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 1994

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time: 2 hours **Maximum Number: 200**

ANCIENT HISTORY

1. The earliest evidence of silver in India is found in the
(a) Harappan culture
(b) Chalcolithic cultures of Western India
(c) Vedic texts
(d) Silver punchmarked coins

Ans. (a) : The earliest evidence of silver in India is found in the Harappan culture.
Most of the things that have been founded by archaeologists are made of stone, shell and metal, including copper, bronze, gold & silver. Gold & silver were used to make ornaments and vessels.

2. Which one of the following usages was a post Vedic development ?
(a) Dharma — Artha — Kama — Moksha
(b) Brahmana—Kshatriya—Vaishya—Shudra
(c) Brahmacharya—Grihastashrama— Vanaprastha — Sanyasa
(d) Indra — Surya — Rudra — Marut

Ans. (c) : During the vedic period the society was organised into four varnas known as varnadharma namely, Brahmin (the learned classes); kshatriya (the warrior classes), vaishya (the business classes), and Shudra (the service classes). Early Hindu philosophy prescribed the four stages of life, that is brahmacharya (the student), grihastha (the householder), vanaprastha (the recluse), and sanyasa (the freeman). It was believed that the law of karma governed the cycle of life from birth to death to re-birth & so on.

3. Which one of the following is the most fundamental difference between Mahayana Buddhism and Hinayana Buddhism ?
(a) Emphasis on ahimsa
(b) Casteless society
(c) Worship of gods and goddesses
(d) Worship of stupa

Ans. (c) : In the Hinayana community, Mahatma Buddha was considered a great man, but in the Mahayana community, he was considered a God & he was worshipped, along with the Buddha Worship of many bodhisattvas also started.

4. "Live well, as long as you live. Live well even by borrowings, for, once cremated, there is no 'return." This rejection of afterlife is an aphorism of the
(a) Kapalika sect
(b) Sunyavada of Nagarjuna
(c) Ajivikas
(d) Charvakas

Ans. (d) : Charvakas said, "Live well, as long as you live. Live well even by borrowings, for once cremated, there is no return".
Charvaka holds direct perception, empiricism, and conditional inference as proper sources of knowledge, embraces philosophical skepticism and rejects ritualism and supernaturalism.
The Charvaka did not believe in karma, rebirth or after life. He believed that there was nothing wrong with sensual pleasure.

5. Vidhushaka, a common character in Sanskrit drama, is invariably a
(a) Brahmana
(b) Kshatriya
(c) Vaisya
(d) Shudra

Ans. (a) : Vidhushaka, a common character in Sanskrit drama, is invariably a 'Brahmana'.
In Sanskrit drama, the 'Vidhushaka' has been used by playwriter like 'kalidas', 'Bhasa', etc. It was often a Brahmin varna and a friend of the king.

6. In the Gandhara sculptures the preaching mudra associated with the Buddha's First Sermon at Sarnath is
(a) abhaya (b) dhyana
(c) dharmachakra (d) bhumisparsa

Ans. (c) : In the Gandhara sculptures the preaching mudra associated with the Buddha's first sermon at sarnath is 'Dharmachakra'.
The statues of Buddha built in the Gandhara sculptures are made of black-grey stone, lime and clay. It depicts Buddha in different postures. Buddha statues are in meditation, padmasana, dharmachakra pravartana, varada & abhaya etc.

7. Toramana belonged to the ethnic horde of the
(a) Scythians (b) Hunas
(c) Yuechis (d) Sakas

Ans. (b) : Toramana was a Hunas. It attacked India during the Guptas period. It was a race living in central Asia. The Yuechis were a genus of the Hunas. Scythians was a branch of Sakas.

8. The name of the poet Kalidasa is mentioned in the
(a) Allahabad pillar inscription
(b) Aihole inscription
(c) Alapadu grant
(d) Hanumakonda inscription

Ans. (b) : The name of the poet Kalidasa is mentioned in the Aihole inscription. The inscription is found at Aihole in Karnataka state. The Aihole inscription was written by the Ravikirti, court poet of Chalukya king, Pulakesin II who reigned from 610 to 642CE.

9. The statue of Gomateswara at Sravanabelagola was built by
(a) Chandragupta Maurya
(b) Kharavela
(c) Amoghavarsha
(d) Chamundaraya

Ans. (d) : Shravanabelagola is home to the 18 m high statue of Lord Gometeshwara; Considered to be one of the world's tallest free-standing monolithic status. Constructed in 981 AD by **Chavundaraya,** a Western Ganga dynasty warrior. It is carved out of a single block of granite and looms on the top of Vindhyagiri Hill.

10. Which one of the following important trade centres of ancient India was on the trade route connecting Kalyana with Vengi ?
(a) Tagara (b) Sripuram
(c) Tripuri (d) Tamralipti

Ans. (a) : Tagara was the important trade centre of ancient India and it was on the trade route connecting kalyana with vengi. It is located on east coast of India and horses, coral and wine were procured and traded with Greek or Roman traders. Unlike other places on the Satavahana period trade routes, which can be physically identified with the places existing today, "Tagara" remained illusive.

11. The caves and rockcut temples at Ellora are
(a) Buddhist
(b) Buddhist and Jain
(c) Hindu and Jain
(d) Hindu, Buddhist and Jain

Ans. (d) : The Ellora Caves chiseled into perfection between the 4th and the 9th century belongs to the Buddhist, Hindu & Jain faiths. One of the most fascinating archoeological sites in Maharashtra, Ellora dates back to the Rashtrakuta dynasty, about 1,500 years ago, and is the epitome of Indian rock-cut architecture. There are in all 34 caves of which 12 are Buddhist, 17 Hindu and 5 Jain.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

12. Who among the following is said to have witnessed the reigns of eight Delhi Sultans?
(a) Ziauddin Barani
(b) Shamsi Siraj Afif
(c) MinhajusSiraj
(d) Amir Khusrau

Ans. (d) : Amir Khusrau witnessed the reigns of eight Delhi sultans. He is regarded as the "Father of Qawwali". Amir Khusrau was an Indian musician, scholar and poet. He is said to have witnessed the reigns of eight Delhi sultans from 'Ghiyasuddin Balban to Sultan Muhammad bin Tughlaq'.

13. The first Indian ruler to organize Haj pilgrimage at the expense of the state was
(a) Alauddin Khilji (b) Feroz Tughlaq
(c) Akbar (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (b) : Firoz Shah Tughlaq was the first Indian ruler to organize Haj pilgrimage at the expense of the state. He was a Muslim ruler of Tughlaq dynasty, who reigned over the Delhi Sultanate from 1351 to 1388. He succeeded to the throne of Delhi Sultanate after the death of Muhammad bin Tughlaq. Firoz Shah Tughlaq is remembered in history abolishing about twenty four types of taxes on people. Even land tax was reduced. He only collected four taxes sanctioned in Quran.

14. The Mansabdari System introduced by Akbar was borrowed from the system followed in
(a) Afghanistan (b) Turkey
(c) Mongolia (d) Persia

Ans. (c) : Akbar introduced Mansabdari system of administration in 1571 with the help of Shahbaz Khan. However, the origin of Mansabdari system can be traced back to Mongols (Changez Khan). In India, it was initially implemented by Babur and Humayun but it was Akbar who reformed and institutionalised the mansabdari system as the basis of civil and military administration.